

CONTRACTS FOR INNOVATION CYMRU – FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS (FAQS)

How does a Contracts for Innovation Cymru Competition work?

Contracts for Innovation Cymru enables government departments to connect with technology organisations, finding innovative solutions to specific public sector challenges and needs. It aims to use the power of government procurement to accelerate technology development, supporting projects through the stages of feasibility and prototyping which are typically hard to fund. Contracts for Innovation Cymru offers an excellent opportunity for businesses, especially early stage companies, to develop and demonstrate technology, supported by an intelligent lead customer.

Contracts for Innovation Cymru is a simple, structured process. Typically, competitions are structured in two phases.

Phase 1 - proposals concentrate on that research and development which will significantly contribute to proving the scientific, technical and commercial feasibility of the proposed project. The results of Phase 1 determine whether the solution should go further to Phase 2, not all projects will progress to Phase 2.

Phase 2 – is where the principal research and development effort takes place and aims to produce a well defined prototype. At the end of Phase 2 it is intended that what has been developed will be manufactured and marketed as a way of fulfilling requirements.

Is my business eligible to submit an application to a Contracts for Innovation Cymru competition?

Any organisation can submit an application, although it is expected that opportunities presented by Contracts for Innovation Cymru will be particularly attractive for SMEs. Contracts for Innovation Cymru is aimed at organisations working on the development of an innovative process, material, device, product or service. Successful applications will be those whose technology best addresses the specific needs identified, with the potential to make a measurable improvement to currently available products, processes materials, devices or services. Development contracts will be awarded only to individual organisations. However, organisations may also wish to demonstrate that successful collaboration will enhance their overall development. Work may be subcontracted but this is the responsibility of the main contractor.

I am a Pre-Startup Company may I apply?

Yes, but contracts must be awarded to legal entities.

I am based at a University, may I apply?

Universities may apply; however they must demonstrate a route to market, i.e. the application must include a plan to commercialise the results.

As a University should I use Full Economic Cost (FEC)?

Full Economic Cost calculations are not relevant in this context. Contracts for Innovation Cymru is a competitive procurement mechanism and tenders will be submitted by a variety of organisations. Whatever calculation you use to arrive at your tender price your application will be assessed against bids from other organisations. You should calculate your tender price bearing this in mind and that your proposal will be assessed as to whether it reflects a fair market value. You are entitled to include overheads but remember that this is a competitive tender.

My company is a Registered Charity, can I apply?

Yes, registered charities are equally eligible to enter Contracts for Innovation Cymru competitions via their trading company limited by guarantee. All organisations must demonstrate a route to market.

How do I submit my application?

Specific details on the challenge and expected outcome of the projects can be found in the Project Documents. You are strongly advised to read all published competition documents before completing the application form.

What is the deadline for applications?

This information will be available on the Contracts for Innovation Cymru Portal <https://sbri.simplydo.co.uk/>

How will the successful applications be chosen?

Proposals will be selected by an expert group of selected assessors and a final assessment panel. Please note all information you provide will be treated with the strictest confidence and used only for assessment purposes.

When will I find out if my application has been successful?

All applicants will be informed shortly after the assessments have been concluded.

Who owns the Intellectual Property generated by the Project?

Intellectual property rights are retained by the applicant although certain rights of usage may be applied by the funding authority including royalty-free, non-exclusive licence rights and the right to require licenses to third parties, at a fair market price.

Can I work in collaboration with other companies?

Contracts will be awarded only to individual organisations. However, applicants may identify components of the work which they wish to subcontract and may also employ specialist consultants or advisers if they believe this will increase the chances of the project being successful.

Do Contracts for Innovation Cymru Contracts Constitute Subsidy Control?

No. Contracts for Innovation Cymru competitions involve procurement of R&D services at a fair market value and are not subject to subsidy control criteria that typically apply to grant funding.

Should Project Costs include VAT?

Yes, VAT is the responsibility of the invoicing business, and it is required that applications will list total costs inclusive of VAT. Should you consider you are VAT exempt then you may quote without VAT but you will not at a later date be able to increase invoice values to cover VAT.

Can Overheads be Included in Project Costs?

An element of overheads may be included in project costs, however such an element must be realistic. Assessors will consider financial costs in terms of 'value for money' at the assessment stage. Projects showing costs that are considered unreasonable will be rejected on these grounds.

Who should I contact if I have any further questions?

Questions should be addressed to ContractsforInnovationCymru@wales.nhs.uk

Questions on the specifics of this competition should be sent to the address provided through the competition link.